

JON SHEPHERD

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Dallas-Fort Worth | Local to Plano, TX | Open to 4 days/week onsite

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Sourcing specialist with 4+ years building ready-now and ready-next talent pipelines for hard-to-fill Finance, Commercial/G&A, and specialized professional roles at Excel Search & Advisory (formerly Nolan Partners). Progressed Researcher → Senior Researcher → Recruiter & Executive Operations Coordinator on sourcing quality, pipeline discipline, and stakeholder trust. Day-to-day craft: talent mapping, Boolean/LinkedIn Recruiter outreach, passive engagement, ATS/CRM hygiene, and market intelligence for hiring leaders and recruiting partners. Sources and qualifies 300+ candidates annually across 75+ cumulative searches. U.S. Air Force veteran and USAA member. Equivalent practical experience in lieu of bachelor's degree.

Core strengths: Talent pipeline development | Sourcing strategy | Boolean & LinkedIn Recruiter | Passive outreach | Talent mapping & market intelligence | Multi-channel sourcing | ATS/CRM discipline | Pipeline metrics | Hard-to-fill / niche roles | Recruiter & hiring-leader partnership

Tools: LinkedIn Recruiter | Boolean / X-ray search | Invenias (ATS/CRM) | ChatGPT / Gemini | Thrive | Salesforce | Pipedrive | Excel | PowerPoint | Outlook

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Excel Search & Advisory (formerly Nolan Partners) | Dallas, TX

Retained search firm supporting hard-to-fill leadership and specialized professional searches.

Recruiter & Executive Operations Coordinator | Jan 2025 → Present

Senior Researcher, Executive Search | Jan 2024 → Jan 2025

Researcher, Executive Search | Dec 2021 → Dec 2023

Sourcing strategy, pipelines, and market intelligence

- Partner with recruiters and hiring leaders to translate hiring needs into targeted, actionable sourcing strategies for specialized and hard-to-fill roles; hand off screened, calibrated pipelines for a clean recruiting transition
- Build and refresh segmented talent pools, market maps, and outreach lists so teams are not starting from zero when critical roles open
- Identify, engage, and convert passive candidates via LinkedIn Recruiter, Boolean/X-ray search, direct outreach, referrals, and professional networks; document engagement history in ATS/CRM
- Deliver market intelligence on talent availability, competitive trends, candidate expectations, and pipeline health to inform search strategy and timelines
- Context-switch across Finance, Commercial/G&A, Operations, and judgment-heavy specialized roles requiring careful screening and discretion
- Source, screen, and qualify 300+ candidates per year across 75+ cumulative searches (mapping, outreach, screening, documentation)
- Track outreach volume, response, and pipeline conversion in structured trackers; adjust targeting and messaging when signals stall
- Use AI tools (ChatGPT/Gemini) to accelerate Boolean construction, outreach personalization, and market research without sacrificing accuracy or compliance discipline
- As Senior Researcher, coached researchers on Boolean/LinkedIn technique, outreach quality, and pipeline hygiene (informal mentoring; not direct reports)

Current Recruiter scope

- Present candidate slates and pipeline recommendations; support interview logistics, references, and offer-stage coordination on live mandates
- Own scorecards/process documentation and partnered on firm process improvements with a third-party vendor
- Promoted to Senior Researcher (2024) and Recruiter & Executive Operations Coordinator (2025) for sourcing performance and delivery reliability

Army and Air Force Exchange Service (AAFES) | Dallas, TX

Personnel Security Specialist | Jun 2020 – Dec 2021

- Adjudicated personnel suitability and trustworthiness; conducted background investigations (law enforcement/credit review) per federal standards
- Processed SF-85/SF-86 and DCSA submissions at ~3% error rate (lowest on team) in a regulated, high-accuracy environment – relevant to niche professional talent and compliance-sensitive hiring

U.S. Air Force, Security Forces | ND, South Korea, HI

On-Scene Commander / Joint Base Defense Operations Controller | Feb 2014 – Apr 2020

- Led mission-critical security and emergency responses; coordinated multi-agency operations under high stakes
- Supported POTUS/Air Force One security operations with Secret Service and OSI
- Improved deployment readiness 33% through workforce planning and roster analysis for 46 personnel

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- High School Diploma – Heritage Christian Academy, Hopkinsville, KY
- 4+ years progressive talent sourcing / pipeline development (degree equivalent via related experience)
- U.S. Air Force Achievement Medal, Kunsan AB, 2017
- U.S. Air Force veteran | Honorable discharge | USAA member